had a file of Time magazines dating back to 1928 and that, since I was faculty, I could take these out. On impulse, I took out the earliest available volume, January to June 1928, and had a fine anachronistic time reliving the Coolidge boom that was taking place while I was living in Miller Avenue.

After that I returned for the next volume and then the next and so on. 6

In doing so, however, I noticed in one of the early volumes a line drawing in a small advertisement which, when I saw it quickly out of the corner of my eye, seemed like the familiar mushroom cloud of the nuclear bomb to me. Rather shaken, for the Time volume dealt with a period that was half a generation before Alamogordo, Hiroshima, and Nagasaki, I took another look. It was only the Old Faithful geyser of Yellowstone National Park and the advertisement was perfectly ordinary.

But at once I thought: What if that were the mushroom cloud? How would a drawing of the nuclear bomb come to be in a magazine that was published many years before 1945? Why should it be there?

I searched for an answer to this question, had to have time travel,

6 It took me nearly a year to move up into the 1950s to the mingled astonishment and amusement of the librarians who, I understood, called me "the Time professor."

had to have a number of things, more and more complicated, and in the end I decided to write a novelette that I named "The End of Eternity" and that I began on December 7, 1953.

20

On November 27, 1953, I received advance copies of the NAL paperback edition of The Currents of Space. It was my first real paperback. About then I also received copies of Lucky Starr and the Pirates of the Asteroids, my second juvenile.

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On December 2, 1953, I began my lab sessions with the student nurses. Between that in the morning and my protein class in the afternoon, my time for anything else vanished into nothing. Worse than that was the fact that I found I didn't like laboratory classes, even when I was in charge. In fact, I've forgotten almost everything about that lab, such was my hatred of it, except